



Ocelots are **good swimmers** and will **catch fish, turtles, and frogs**

Ocelot

Leopardus pardalis

The ocelot is the largest of three small, spotted cats native to Central and South American forests. Its patterned coat and stealthy, mainly nocturnal, habits ensure that the cat is rarely seen. Much of what we know about the species comes from analyzing its droppings, and radio-tracking. Ocelots have been tracked traveling long distances at night, with adult females ranging up to 3 miles (4km) and males 5 miles (7.5 km).

Lone ranger

Ocelots become active in the late afternoon, and hunt by patrolling areas of thick cover. They prefer to feed on small ground-dwelling rodents, particularly rats, but can take young deer, wild pigs, and sloths. More unusual prey include lizards, land crabs, birds, fish, and frogs. Ocelots are agile climbers, often resting in trees during the day. Like most cats, they are solitary—adults socialize only during the breeding season. An adult male's home range overlaps with that of several females. The females breed once every two years and usually give birth to just one cub after 80 days.



◁ AMBITIOUS HUNTER

Ocelots will catch prey half their weight, such as green iguanas. To avoid the reptile's claws and lashing tail, a hunting ocelot will aim for the fleshy throat for a quick dispatch.

▷ DAPPLED FUR

The ocelot's spotted coat provides excellent camouflage among foliage. In the past, this species was heavily hunted to supply the fur trade.

